



EID AL FITR PRAYERS AT TAJ MAHAL

The faithful offer prayers on Eid Al Fitr that marks the end of Ramadan, inside the complex of the Taj Mahal in Agra, India, yesterday. Besides India, which began Eid celebrations in various parts of the country yesterday, Pakistan, Bangladesh, Indonesia, Malaysia, Oman, Egypt, Syria, Jordan, Morocco, Iraq, Tunisia and Libya also celebrated the first day of Eid Al Fitr yesterday.

UK imposes travel permit on Europeans from tomorrow

Britain says ETA can be bought online and will strengthen border security

LONDON

In a shake-up of long-standing travel rules, European nationals heading to the UK will from tomorrow need a mandatory entry permit, which the British government says will strengthen border security.

The Electronic Travel Authorisation (ETA) can be bought online in the next few days for £10 (€12), but the price is rising swiftly from April 9 to £16.

It is similar to the ESTA system in operation in the United States and will be mandatory

SCHEME EXPANDED

- The scheme was first launched in 2023 for Qatar, before being extended to six regional Gulf neighbours — UAE, Saudi Arabia, Oman, Kuwait, Bahrain and Jordan.
- In January, it was expanded to nationals of around another 50 countries and territories, including Argentina, South Korea and New Zealand.
- Almost 1.1 million visitors were issued with ETAs before the end of 2024, according to the Home Office.
- It is not applicable to UK residents or anyone who already has a UK immigration status.

—AFP

for all European visitors to Britain from tomorrow, following its roll-out for US, Canadian and other visa-exempt nationals in January.

The permit allows visits of up to six months and is valid for two years. It is required for all travellers including minors

and babies. From tomorrow, nationals of some 30 European countries — including all those in the European Union except Ireland — will need to carry the electronic permit to enter Britain, which left the EU in 2020.

— AFP

Staycations the way to go for Dubai residents this Eid

With airfares rising, a number of people have chosen to skip trips abroad

DUBAI

BY ASHWANI KUMAR
Chief Reporter

With a variety of scenic locales to explore in the country coupled with savings on soaring airfare prices, time, and other expenses, a trip to local attractions is a wise decision for a growing number of Dubai residents during the Eid Al Fitr holidays.

So, Maroun Farah is on a road trip to Ras Al Khaimah with his family, including three children, while Khaled Osman, a father of two boys, is visiting Hatta.

Manoj Sadanandan, on the other hand, has cut short his leave and returned to Dubai in time to celebrate the festival

with his friends Pradeep K.N. and Lince Jose by visiting local attractions.

No hassle

“For our family, it’s all about making the most of our time and budget. I decided to visit RAK well in advance as it offers the perfect getaway with its beautiful beaches, luxury resorts, and adventure activities in the Jebel Jais mountains — all without the hassle of international travel,” Farah told *Gulf News*.

Osman, who is bowled over by the beauty of Hatta, asked, “Why leave the country when you have such exotic places to visit here?”

Sadanandan underlined that for Dubai residents, the best vacation is just a drive away. “I can’t think of any other city to celebrate Eid — surrounded by my friends, the vibrant energy of the city, countless places to explore, and delicious food to savour.”

SEE ALSO P2

Trump: US tariffs to hit all countries

TARIFFS WOULD BE MORE ‘GENEROUS’ THAN THOSE LEVIED AGAINST THE US

WASHINGTON

President Donald Trump said Sunday the tariffs he plans to impose in the coming days would include “all countries”, not just those with the largest trade imbalances with the United States.

Trump promised a “Liberation Day” tomorrow, when he is set to unveil reciprocal levies to address trade practices that his government deems unfair.

“You’d start with all countries, so let’s see what happens,” Trump told reporters onboard Air Force One, dashing hopes he might scale back some of the threatened levies or that they would target a select group with persistent trade imbalances.

“I haven’t heard a rumour about 15 countries, 10 or 15,” he said when asked which nations would be affected. “Essentially all of the countries that we’re talking about. We’ve been talking about all countries, not a cutoff,” he said, without giving details.

‘Dirty 15’

Trump’s upcoming tariff salvo had been expected to target the 15 per cent of partners that have persistent trade imbalances with the United States, a group Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent called a “Dirty 15.” Among US trading partners in the firing line are China, EU, Mexico, Vietnam, Taiwan, Japan, South Korea, Canada, India and Thailand.

But despite widening the target, the president insisted his



They ripped us off like no country has ever been ripped off in history and we’re going to be much nicer than they were to us. But it’s substantial money for the country nevertheless.”

Donald Trump
US President

tariffs would be more “generous” than those levied against the United States.

“The tariffs will be far more generous than those countries were to us, meaning they will be kinder than those countries were to the United States of America over the decades,” he said.

“They ripped us off like no country has ever been ripped off in history and we’re going to be much nicer than they were to us. But it’s substantial money for the country nevertheless,” he said.

Trump has already slapped tariffs on steel and aluminium imports and additional levies on imports from China.

Tariffs on imported autos are also due to take effect on April 3.

Trump’s top trade aide Peter Navarro said the tax on auto imports could raise \$100 billion a year. “The other tariffs are going to raise about \$600 billion a year, about \$6 trillion over a 10-year period,” Navarro said.

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